

Background

- In a clinical trial, the overall study duration is divided into distinct periods of time called epochs
- Each epoch will have a specific purpose - like screening, treatment, follow-up
- Each epoch will have a specific start and end date/time
- There are no gaps between two contiguous epochs
- Reviewers of clinical trial will be interested in understanding the epoch in which an event or intervention started or the epoch in which a specific collection is made
- For this purpose, we create EPOCH variable in SDTM domains
- For events and interventions domains, we use start date of the observation to derive epoch
- In findings domains, we use the collection date to derive epoch variable
- We compare the date of interest with the start and end date of each element and assign the epoch based on the interval in which it falls

What will we learn in this lesson?

- In this lesson, we will see how to derive EPOCH variable using a date variable and comparing it with each epoch start and end dates in SE (subject elements) dataset

	Start	End
Screening		
Treatment		
Follow-up		